30000 - 40000	20
40000 - 50000	12
50000 and above	10

3.6.4 Guidelines on Compilation of Continuous Frequency Distribution

The following guidelines may be followed for compiling the continuous frequency distribution.

- The values given in the data set must be contained within one (and only one) class and overlapping classes must not occur.
- The classes must be arranged in the order of their magnitude.
- Normally a frequency distribution may have 8 to 10 classes. It is not desirable to have less than 5 and more than 15 classes.
- Frequency distributions having equal class widths throughout are preferable. When this is not possible, classes with smaller or larger widths can be used. Open ended classes are acceptable but only in the first and the last classes of the distribution.
- It should be noted that in a frequency distribution, the first class should contain the lowest value and the last class should contain the highest value.
- The number of classes may be determined by using the Sturges formula $k = 1 + 3.322\log_{10}N$, where N is the total frequency and k is the number of classes.

3.7 Cumulative Frequency Distribution

Cumulative frequency corresponding to a class interval is defined as the total frequency of all values less than upper boundary of the class. A tabular arrangement of all cumulative frequencies together with the corresponding classes is called a cumulative frequency distribution or cumulative frequency table.

The main difference between a frequency distribution and a cumulative frequency distribution is that in the former case a particular class interval according to how many items lie within it is described, whereas in the latter case the number of items that have values either above or below a particular level is described.

There are two forms of cumulative frequency distributions, which are defined as follows:

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